



The People of Africa

FROM THE DESERT
merchants in the north to the
Pygmy peoples in the central rain forests, and the nomadic herdsmen of the south, people
have always moved around this enormous continent with little regard to national borders.
In recent times there have also been very large migrations toward the cities.

A young Kenyan girl
with the Nairobi
skyline behind her.



BIG CITY

With the rapid growth of cities comes a host of problems. Kenya's capital, Nairobi, is the biggest city in east Africa, and also the site of possibly the continent's biggest slum. Almost one million people live here with no sanitation facilities.

Teenage boys
reading about
AIDS prevention.



INDEPENDENCE

Much of Africa was colonized by European powers, particularly the English and French, in the 18th, 19th, and early 20th centuries. Some countries retain strong links with their former colonial rulers. Here, the president of Ivory Coast greets the Prime Minister of France, who is making a diplomatic visit.

A DEVASTATING PLAGUE

AIDS, a sexually transmitted disease, has been ravaging the African continent. There is no cure for the disease, and the drugs used to treat it are very expensive. Tragically, so many adults have died that in some areas there are no parents or schoolteachers, and children are having to be brought up by their grandparents.